

SCHOOLS OF VEDANTA (VEDĀNTA)

CANON AND SCHOOL TAXONOMY → ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND → WITNESS, REFLECTION AND KNOWLEDGE → WORLD, CAUSATION AND IGNORANCE → SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT → QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CANON AND SCHOOL TAXONOMY

CANON AND SCHOOL TAXONOMY THREEFOLD CANON UPANISADS + BHAGAVAD GITA + BRAHMA SUTRA BADARAYANA SYSTEMATIZES; RIVAL COMMENTARIES BUILD DISTINCT SCHOOLS NON-DUAL ULTIMATE REALITY; DIFFERENCE BELONGS TO IGNORANCE QUALIFIED UNITY; SELVES AND WORLD ARE REAL MODES GOD, SELVES AND WORLD ARE ETERNALLY DIFFERENT REALITIES

THREEFOLD CANON: UPANISADS + BHAGAVAD GITA + BRAHMA SUTRA

Badarayana systematizes; rival commentaries build distinct schools

Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance

Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- THREEFOLD CANON: UPANISADS + BHAGAVAD GITA + BRAHMA SUTRA
- Badarayana systematizes; rival commentaries build distinct schools

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance
- Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities
- THREEFOLD CANON: UPANISADS + BHAGAVAD GITA + BRAHMA SUTRA

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities.

01

STAGE 01 ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELF

ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELF ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) LORD (ĪŚVARA) TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) QUALITYLESS ULTIMATE REALITY; EMPIRICAL LORD UNDER ILLUSION PERSONAL QUALIFIED ULTIMATE REALITY WITH INSEPARABLE MODES INDEPENDENT LORD AND PERMANENTLY DEPENDENT SELVES TRAP THE THREE SCHOOLS DO NOT USE THE SAME WORD

ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)

Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes

Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap: the three schools do not use

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)
- Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes
- Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)
- Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology.

02

STAGE 02 WITNESS, REFLECTION AND KNOWLEDGE

WITNESS, REFLECTION AND KNOWLEDGE DEEP SLEEP NON-DUAL WITNESS ORIGINAL-REFLECTION IS A LATER EXPLANATORY FAMILY, NOT DEEP CONTEMPLATION STABILIZES IDENTITY-KNOWLEDGE ATOMIC KNOWER WITH EXPANDING ATTRIBUTIVE CONSCIOUSNESS TRAP DO NOT CALL LORD (ĪŚVARA) BOTH ORIGINAL AND REFLECTION

WAKING → DREAM → DEEP SLEEP → NON-DUAL WITNESS original-reflection is a later

explanatory family, not literal optics hearing → reflection → deep contemplation stabilizes identity-knowledge

Ramanuja: atomic knower with expanding attributive consciousness trap: do not call Lord (īśvara) both original

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WAKING → DREAM → DEEP SLEEP → NON-DUAL WITNESS original-reflection is a later
- explanatory family, not literal optics hearing → reflection → deep contemplation stabilizes identity-knowledge

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Ramanuja: atomic knower with expanding attributive consciousness trap: do not call Lord (īśvara) both original and reflection without naming the model
- WAKING → DREAM → DEEP SLEEP → NON-DUAL WITNESS original-reflection is a later

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- explanatory family, not literal optics hearing → reflection → deep contemplation stabilizes identity-knowledge
- Ramanuja: atomic knower with expanding attributive consciousness trap: do not call Lord (īśvara) both original and reflection without naming the model

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: atomic knower with expanding attributive consciousness trap: do not call Lord (īśvara) both original and reflection without naming the model.

03

STAGE 03 WORLD, CAUSATION AND IGNORANCE

WORLD, CAUSATION AND IGNORANCE APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) REAL TRANSFORMATION OF DEPENDENT MODES WITHIN ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN)'S GOD EFFICIENT CAUSE; DEPENDENT PRIMORDIAL MATTER MATERIAL CAUSE INDESCRIBABLE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA)
- Ramanuja: real transformation of dependent modes within Ultimate reality (Brahman)'s body

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Madhva: God efficient cause
- dependent primordial matter material cause indescribable illusion (māyā) projects

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies vivarta develops causal dependence but rejects real transformation
- ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Madhva: God efficient cause; dependent primordial matter material cause indescribable illusion (māyā) projects; ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies vivarta develops causal dependence but rejects real transformation.

04

STAGE 04 SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT

SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION BONDAGE GREAT STATEMENT 'THAT THOU ART' REQUIRES DISCARDING INCOMPATIBLE IF IGNORANCE IS INDEFINABLE, ITS LOCUS AND REMOVAL REMAIN

SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible

it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory
- it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory
- it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory
- it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory explains rope-snake without making error unreal knowledge removes ignorance; it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested.

05

STAGE 05 QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM

QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) SELVES AND WORLD ARE REAL BUT THE WHOLE CONTROLS AND SUPPORTS ITS REAL MODES ACTION UNITY WITHOUT ILLUSIONISM; LIMIT PLURALITY MAY QUALIFY ABSOLUTENESS

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality

devotion/surrender and grace liberate attributive consciousness expands without loss of individuality strength: unity without illusionism

limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the
- devotion/surrender and grace liberate attributive consciousness expands without loss of individuality strength: unity without illusionism

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness
- INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- devotion/surrender and grace liberate attributive consciousness expands without loss of individuality strength: unity without illusionism
- limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the whole controls and supports its real modes action and knowledge prepare; devotion/surrender and grace liberate attributive consciousness expands without loss of individuality strength: unity without illusionism; limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness.

06

STAGE 06 DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAŅCAVIDHA-BHEDA) WORLD-WORLD DIFFERENCE IS REAL, ETERNAL AND CONSTITUTIVE RATHER THAN GOD IS EFFICIENT, NOT MATERIAL CAUSE; SOULS AND MATTER ROBUST REALISM; LIMIT PERMANENT HIERARCHY AND PLURALISM NEED DEFENCE

FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAŅCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced

God is efficient, not material cause

souls and matter remain dependent liberation preserves hierarchy, difference and blissful service strength: robust realism

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAŅCAVIDHA-BHEDA)
- world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God is efficient, not material cause
- souls and matter remain dependent liberation preserves hierarchy, difference and blissful service strength: robust realism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence
- FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAŅCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is efficient, not material cause; souls and matter remain dependent liberation preserves hierarchy, difference and blissful service strength: robust realism; limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence.

07

STAGE 07 WIDER VEDANTA AND LIBERATION

WIDER VEDANTA AND LIBERATION COMMUNION; DVAITA GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE UNCHANGED REAL MANIFESTATION + GRACE-NOURISHED DEVOTION INCONCEIVABLE DIFFERENCE-NON-DIFFERENCE + DIVINE LOVE NIMBARKA MATTER ORDINARY MATTER + DIVINE MATTER + TIME NEVER COLLAPSE

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

VISISTADVAITA → COMMUNION; DVAITA → GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE

Vallabha: unchanged real manifestation + grace-nourished devotion

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

Caitanya: inconceivable difference-non-difference + divine love

Nimbarka matter: ordinary matter + divine matter + time never collapse the 2018 liberation comparison into generic devotion

EVALUATION / TRAP

VISISTADVAITA → COMMUNION; DVAITA → GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE

Vallabha: unchanged real manifestation + grace-nourished devotion

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- VISISTADVAITA → COMMUNION; DVAITA → GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE
- Vallabha: unchanged real manifestation + grace-nourished devotion

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Caitanya: inconceivable difference-non-difference + divine love
- Nimbarka matter: ordinary matter + divine matter + time never collapse the 2018 liberation comparison into generic devotion

EVALUATION / TRAP

- VISISTADVAITA → COMMUNION; DVAITA → GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE
- Vallabha: unchanged real manifestation + grace-nourished devotion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nimbarka matter: ordinary matter + divine matter + time never collapse the 2018 liberation comparison into generic devotion.

08

STAGE 08 PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS DEFINE COMMON QUESTION BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST TEST OBJECTIONS ULTIMATE REALITY LIBERATION USE ONE PRECISE DOCTRINE AND ONE RIVAL CRITICISM UNITY, QUALIFIED UNITY AND DIFFERENCE SOLVE DIFFERENT PRESSURES

DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self →

→ liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what

and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error
- liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures
- DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves
- and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — THE VEDANTA MAP ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN), CAUSATION AND ADVAITA MEANS OF VALID OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — LORD (ĪŚVARA), TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) ORIGINAL, REFLECTION, MODE OR DEPENDENT SELF OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — WORLD (JAGAT) AND CAUSATION APPEARANCE, DIVINE BODY OR REAL DEPENDENT WORLD OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — INDESCRIBABLE ILLUSION (MĀYĀ), IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Vedanta Map: Ultimate reality (brahman), Causation and Advaita Means of valid knowledge (pramānas)
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Lord (īśvara), True self (ātman) and Individual self (jiva): Original, Reflection, Mode or Dependent Self
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — World (jagat) and Causation: Appearance, Divine Body or Real Dependent World
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Indescribable illusion (māyā), Ignorance (avidyā) and Superimposition (adhyāsa): How Advaita Explains Bondage

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Liberation (mokṣa) Across Vedanta: Recognition, Communion, Service and Grace
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Ramanuja's Qualified Non-Dualism: Inseparable dependence (aprthaksiddhi) and the Body-Soul Model
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Madhva and Wider Vedanta: Five Differences, Nimbarka, Vallabha and Caitanya
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — Great Upanishadic statement (mahāvākya) and Error

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Tat Tvam Asi, Superimposition (adhyāsa) and Indescribable-error theory (anirvacaniya-khyāti)
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 9 — Absolutism, Inter-school Debates and the Critique of Vedanta
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 10 — PYQ Routing, Presupposition Ledgers and Answer Architecture
- The Taittiriya and Chandogya teaching of an ultimate source is therefore read through

OPTIONAL STATUS This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.